

ETEN MENTORSHIP MODULE

Product Requirements Document (PRD)

Release 1: Mentorship Circles

Scope of this PRD

This PRD covers Release 1 (Mentorship Circles) in full product depth — problem, goals, metrics, personas, user stories and prioritized requirements. Phase 2 and Phase 3+ are summarised as future vision in Section 12 only; they are not being scoped for build here.

Prepared for: Expervia Product, Engineering and Design

Based on: ETEN Mentorship & Capability Accelerator Framework v1.0; ETEN Mentorship Module Engineering Requirements v1.0

Version: 1.0 — Ready for cross-functional review

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1. Overview and Problem Statement

ETEN members today move from registration through certification largely alone. Certification does not reliably convert into practical capability or commercial readiness — the gap between “credentialed” and “deployable” is exactly where members disengage and where Expervia loses potential commercial supply. There is no structured, verified way for an experienced member to guide a less-experienced one toward a specific readiness milestone, and no mechanism that turns that guidance into evidence ETEN can trust.

Mentorship Circles is the first release of the ETEN Mentorship & Capability Accelerator: a small-group, Pod-based mentorship format that gives members a guided path from their current V-level toward a target V-level, and produces verifiable evidence along the way.

One-line description

A structured, Pod-based group mentorship programme that moves ETEN members toward a defined capability goal and logs the evidence that results.

2. Goals and Non-Goals

2.1 Goals (Release 1)

- Give members a structured, guided path from their current V-level to a defined target V-level.
- Convert experienced members' time into verifiable capability-progression evidence, not just informal advice.
- Strengthen Pod Leaders' existing “develop future leaders” mandate with a concrete operating mechanism.
- Prove the mentorship model works, cheaply, before any platform investment in matching, marketplace or payment features.
- Create the first repeatable link between Academy participation and commercial-readiness evidence.

2.2 Non-Goals (Release 1)

- Building a mentor marketplace, search or self-serve request flow.
- Paying mentors or processing any financial transaction.
- Supporting 1:1, Project or Executive mentorship formats.
- Automated or algorithmic matching of mentors to mentees.
- Scoring or ranking mentors.

3. Success Metrics

Targets below are illustrative design targets for the pilot, not validated benchmarks — they should be revisited after the first cohort using the same discipline the Playbook applies to its own illustrative figures elsewhere.

Metric	Definition	Pilot target
Circles launched	Mentorship Circles running to completion	3 (one per initial capability cell: Modern Work, Data & AI, Business Applications)
Mentee enrolment	Members enrolled across pilot Circles	15–30

Metric	Definition	Pilot target
Verified Mentors onboarded	Mentor Candidates approved before launch	≥3 (one per pilot Circle)
First-value time	Days from enrolment to first attended session	≤7 days (matches the Playbook's existing First-value SLA)
Circle completion rate	Mentees completing the full scheduled duration	≥70%
Evidence conversion	Completing mentees with at least one new capability-passport evidence record	≥50%
Mentor engagement	Mentor session-attendance rate across the pilot	≥80%

4. Target Users

Persona	Ada — Mentee, V1 Credential Verified
Goal	Reach V3 (Commercially Ready) in Data & AI within 90 days.
Pain point today	Passed a certification but has never done real project work; doesn't know what "ready" actually looks like or who to ask.
How Phase 1 helps	Gets a Circle, a mentor, a structured target and sessions that produce evidence toward V3 — not just more content to read alone.

Persona	Chidi — Mentor, V4 Proven Specialist
Goal	Build leadership evidence toward Pod Leadership without an open-ended, unpaid time commitment.
Pain point today	Willing to help but wary of informal requests that never end and are never recognised.
How Phase 1 helps	A bounded, verified role (one Circle, fixed duration) with visible recognition and a defined path to Senior/Expert Mentor status.

Persona	Grace — Pod Leader
Goal	Grow verified, deployable capacity inside her Pod without doing all the coaching herself.
Pain point today	Has no formal mechanism for the "develop future leaders" responsibility already on her role — today it's ad hoc.
How Phase 1 helps	A concrete tool: nominate mentors, assemble Circles from her own roster, see progress across her Pod.

Persona	Verification Desk Reviewer — Commercial Readiness Panel
Goal	Approve mentors without creating a second, weaker trust system alongside the existing V0–V5 model.

Pain point today	Worried that a mentorship feature could let unverified members present themselves as experts.
How Phase 1 helps	Mentor verification reuses the same evidence and the same panel already used for member readiness.

5. User Stories (Release 1)

As a...	I want to...	So that...
Pod Leader	nominate a member of my Pod as a Mentor Candidate	capable members can be formally recognised and used as mentors
Verification Desk reviewer	review a Mentor Candidate's existing evidence	I can approve mentors without a new, separate verification process
Pod Leader	create a Circle with a Verified Mentor and up to 10 mentees from my Pod	I can run structured group mentorship without manual coordination overhead
Mentee	set a single target V-level and capability goal when I join a Circle	my mentorship is structured around a specific, measurable outcome
Mentor	log attendance and post assignments each session	I have a simple, low-effort way to run and track my Circle
Mentee	submit evidence against an assignment and see my mentor's feedback	I know exactly what I still need to demonstrate
Mentor	approve a mentee's evidence	it counts toward their real capability record, not just my private notes
Mentee	see approved evidence appear on my capability passport	my mentorship progress becomes part of my verified profile, not a separate record
Mentee	receive recognition when I complete my Circle	my contribution and progress are visible, not just implied
Pod Leader	see progress across every Circle in my Pod	I know where to intervene before a Circle stalls

6. Requirements (Prioritized)

P0 = required to launch the pilot. P1 = required soon after, before wider rollout beyond the pilot cells. P2 = valuable but can slip past Release 1 without blocking the pilot.

Priority	Requirement
P0	Pod Leader can nominate a Mentor Candidate from their own Pod
P0	Verification Desk can approve/reject a Mentor Candidate using existing evidence
P0	Pod Leader can create a Circle (1 mentor, 1-10 mentees, all from their Pod)
P0	Mentee can set a target V-level and capability area on enrolment
P0	Mentor can log session attendance
P0	Mentor can post an assignment and mentee can submit evidence
P0	Mentor can approve evidence, and approved evidence is written to the mentee's capability passport
P0	Access is restricted to the assigned mentor, enrolled mentees and owning Pod Leader
P1	Automatic recognition (badge + Expert Score credit) on completion
P1	Pod Leader view of progress across all Circles in their Pod

Priority	Requirement
P1	Basic session-reminder and assignment-due notifications
P2	Academy-provided assignment templates (vs. mentor writing assignments from scratch)
P2	Simple per-mentee progress indicator (sessions attended / assignments approved)

7. Key User Flows

Detailed screen-by-screen requirements are in the Engineering Requirements Document (Section 4.2–4.3). At the product level, Release 1 has four flows:

- Mentor verification — Pod Leader nominates → Verification Desk approves/rejects using existing evidence.
- Circle setup — Pod Leader assembles a Circle from their own Pod; each mentee sets one structured goal.
- Running a Circle — mentor logs sessions, posts assignments, reviews and approves mentee evidence.
- Completion — approved evidence lands on the mentee's capability passport; completion triggers recognition.

Design principle: every screen should assume the user already knows their Pod and their V-level — this module should never ask a member to re-enter information ETEN already has.

8. Out of Scope (Release 1)

- Automated or algorithmic mentor–mentee matching.
- Mentor Marketplace (search, filters, self-serve request, public directory).
- Any payment, invoicing or payout mechanism.
- 1:1, Project and Executive Mentorship formats.
- Mentor Score or any automated mentor ranking.
- Reverse mentorship, corporate/university/sponsored programme tooling.

9. Assumptions and Dependencies

- At least one V2+ member per pilot capability cell is willing to become a Verified Mentor — if not, the pilot needs a founder/leadership-nominated mentor to bootstrap the first cohort.
- The existing Pod, Member, Verification and capability-passport systems can support the read/write integration described in the Engineering Requirements Document (Section 2); this needs engineering confirmation before final estimation.
- Pod Leaders have the time and willingness to manually assemble Circles in Release 1 — no matching engine exists to do this for them.
- Existing membership terms and consent already cover mentorship participation; no new legal/consent flow is assumed unless legal advises otherwise.

10. Risks

Risk	Impact if unaddressed	Mitigation
Cold start — no Verified Mentors at launch	Pilot cannot begin in a capability cell	Leadership/Pod Leaders directly nominate and fast-track the first mentor per cell before general rollout
Mentor burnout / unpaid load	Mentor drop-off mid-Circle, damaging mentee trust	Cap mentor load to one Circle at a time in Release 1; recognition is visible from day one even without payment
Low mentee enrolment	Circles too small to be worthwhile	Pilot only in the three initial capability cells where Pod density already exists
Mentor-quality erosion	Mentee complaints, no real progression, damage to trust model	Verification stays inside the existing Readiness Panel; no self-nomination without Pod Leader sign-off
Scope creep into marketplace/matching/payment	Release 1 timeline slips chasing Phase 2/3 features	This PRD's Section 8 and the Engineering Requirements Document's deferral list are the standing scope boundary

11. Rollout Plan

Illustrative sequencing — engineering owns final estimation (see Engineering Requirements Document, Section 11).

Stage	Content
Build	Mentor nomination/verification → Circle creation → session/assignment/evidence logging → dashboards → recognition triggers
Bootstrap	Leadership nominates at least one Verified Mentor per pilot cell ahead of general Pod Leader nomination
Pilot	One Circle per initial capability cell (Modern Work, Data & AI, Business Applications), timed to the next commercial-readiness sprint
Review	Assess against Section 3 success metrics at pilot completion before nominating additional Pod Leaders to create Circles

12. Future Vision (Not in This Release)

Full detail lives in the Framework (Sections 4, 9, 10) and the Engineering Requirements Document (Sections 8–9). Summary only:

- Phase 2 — 1:1 Mentorship, Project Mentorship, and the first paid product (a 12-Week Career & Capability Accelerator combining Circle + Academy + evidence), once Release 1 proves out.
- Phase 3+ — Mentor Marketplace, Mentor Score, Executive Mentorship, Reverse Mentorship, and corporate/university/sponsored programmes.

13. Open Questions

- What happens if a mentee wants to leave a Circle mid-cohort — do they keep partial evidence, or does the goal reset?

- Is there a minimum viable Circle size (e.g. 3) below which a Pod Leader shouldn't launch one, or is any size acceptable in the pilot?
- Do Pod Leaders need enablement material (a short guide or session template) to run their first Circle well, or is the tool itself sufficient?
- Should mentorship be introduced to the full existing membership at once, or soft-launched only inside the three pilot cells until Section 3 targets are met?
- Who reviews the pilot's Section 3 metrics and makes the go/no-go call to expand beyond the pilot cells?

14. References

- ETEN Mentorship & Capability Accelerator Framework v1.0 — business rationale, phasing discipline, commercialisation sequencing.
- ETEN Mentorship Module Engineering Requirements v1.0 — screens, functional requirements, data model, technical open questions.
- ETEN/Expervia Commercialization Engine & Monetization Playbook v1.3 — Member Journey (Section 12), First-value SLA (12.1), Metric Tree (17.2).